

eCMS Issues Publishing to Contract Opportunities

May 2021

Revision Historyadaaa

The revision history cycle begins once changes or enhancements are requested after the document has been baselined.

Date	Version	Description	Author
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Purpose

The purpose of this document is to provide Centeva personnel with best practices for helping their OPAL customers to publish their eCMS Documents to Contract Opportunities through eCMS. Error images and their solutions are included to allow you to trouble-shoot issues quickly.

How to Successfully Publish

1. User must have an account on Beta.sam.gov
2. User must have Contracting Officer role under Contract Opportunities for their contracting site
3. eCMS Account needs to reflect same email address used on beta.sam.gov (VA email)
4. eCMS Action needs to have same Contracting Office Code as user's account on Contract Opportunities
5. Contract Opportunities documents have required fields which must be filled out to publish.
6. If Contract Opportunities doc has a "SAM Description" segment in Content Manager, it must be filled out.
7. Solicitation cannot be archived

Troubleshooting - General

1. Any notice:
 - a. If it is archived on Contract Opportunities, user will not be able to publish an amendment. You may need to go to
2. Award Notices
 - a. If Award Date was over 99 days ago, system will not let you publish an Award Notice through eCMS (because you can only use two digits for "Inactive Date" data field on Contract Opportunities doc and the Inactive Date can't be in the past).
 - b. For these documents, they need to be manually published.
3. Special Notices
 - a. eCMS only lets you publish one Special Notice per solicitation (even if you create an Amendment document). "Mod to Previous Presol" and "Amend to Previous Combined" cannot be used to amend a "Special Notice" doc, you will get an error.
 - b. Any subsequent Special Notices need to be manually published.

Error Messages

Contract Award Number max length is 255 characters and allows only alphanumeric and - _ () {} characters with no spaces.

Publish Document: 47QTCA18D0081 36C10B20F0008_1

Solicitation Number: 36C10B19Q0538

Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFQ	7/19/2019			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	FSS-ORDER		N/A	N/A	N/A

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Contract Award Number max length is 255 characters and allows only alphanumeric and - _ () {} characters with no spaces.

[47QTCA18D0081 36C10B20F0008_1 File Attachments](#)

- ☒ 47QTCA18D0081 36C10B20F0008_1
- ☒ JA_Signature-SAS_Redacted.pdf

Reason for Error: This usually only occurs for Order action types because the system does not like that there is a space between the contract # and the order # in the "Award Number" field in the Award Notice segment.

Solution: Have the user enter an underscore "_" between the base contract number and order number in the Award Number field:

Document Fill-Ins

Form: AWARD Award Notice

Previous Next Select Segment Data Value View Form View Document Zoom:

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY SUBJECT 1:	TAC-20-54740	POC Information Automatically Filled from User Profile Unless Entered)	joshua.titsmaurice@va.gov 240-215-8890
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY SUBJECT 2:		AWARD INFORMATION	
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY SUBJECT 3:		AWARD NUMBER *	47QTCA18D0081_36C10B20F0008
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY SUBJECT 4:		AWARD AMOUNT *	\$23,203.00
CONTRACTING OFFICE ZIP CODE:	07724	LINE ITEM NUMBER	
SOLICITATION NUMBER:	36C10B19Q053	AWARD DATE (MM-DD-YYYY) *	10-01-2019
ARCHIVE DELAY:	30	AWARDEE NAME *	EXECUTIVE INFORMATION SYSTEMS, LLC
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY SET ASIDE:		CONTRACTOR'S DUNS NUMBER	938289527
ISSUED BY: NAME LINE 1:	Department of	AWARDEE ADDRESS LINE 1 *	
		AWARDEE ADDRESS LINE 2 *	
		AWARDEE ADDRESS LINE 3 *	6901 ROCKLEDGE DRIVE STE 600
		AWARDEE ADDRESS LINE 4 *	
		AWARDEE CITY	BETHESDA

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OK

Email Template: work with them to enter the underscore, resave the word document and try to publish again

Description is Missing

Publish Document: SPE2D1-19-D-0018 36A79720F0019_1

Solicitation Number: 36A79720F0019

Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	HTME-ORDER	Publish	P/A	P/A	P/A

Description is missing

Note: Ensure the document is in draft state prior to modifying data values.

Available Document and Attachment Files

☒ SPE2D1-19-D-0018 36A79720F0019_1

Reason for Error: "SAM Description" is a required segment in the Content Manager.

Solution: Confirm that the user has entered a description in the "SAM Description" segment and the document is ready to publish. At this time, this error does not have a workaround in eCMS and the document will need to be manually published.

Email Template: send to VA Acquisition Systems Help Desk

Draft record already exists.

****For manual publishing only.**

Reason for Error: There already is a draft record for the requirement on Contract Opportunities. You won't be able to edit the record until the draft is deleted/completed.

Solution: If the draft record already exists. Review the record to see if it needs to be published or deleted. Then proceed accordingly.

Email Template:

I was able to publish your document manually in Contract Opportunity.

Edit Check requiring "Sam Order Number"

The screenshot shows a web application window titled "Document Edit Checks" with a subtitle "CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES VA791-17-D-0001_2". In the top right corner are icons for help, zoom, and close. Below the title bar is a "Go to question" button and a "Go" button. The main content area contains a yellow box with the following text: "To submit a notice to the Contract Opportunities website, all required information must be provided prior to publishing. At this time the system will verify that the required information has been provided in order to publish to Contract Opportunities." and "The Order Number is a required field in order to publish to SAM. This field cannot be left blank." Below this is a label "Enter the SAM Order Number." and an empty text input field with a help icon. At the bottom are three buttons: "PREVIOUS" (blue), "NEXT" (blue), and "EXIT" (red).

Reason for Edit Check Error: Award Notices require the Action ID for the award, it cannot be blank.

Solution: enter the award action ID and resave the document and have user try again

Email Template: work with customer to get it published

End element "additionalinfo" from namespace "expected. Found element "content" from namespace.

Publish Document: 36E79720R0048_2

Solicitation Number: 36E79720R0048

Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFP	5/14/2020		
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFP		5/29/2020	N/A

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
End element 'additionalInfo' from namespace '' expected. Found element 'content' from namespace ''.

36E79720R0048_2 File Attachments

☒ 36E79720R0048_2

Reason for Error: System Bug

Solution: Confirm that the document is ready to publish. At this time, this error does not have a workaround in eCMS and the document will need to be manually published.

Email Template: send to VA Acquisition Systems Help Desk

Inactive date provided is in the past

Publish Document: 36F79719D0260

Solicitation Number: 65

Document History	Action Type	FBO	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	65BA-FSS		N/A	N/A	N/A

FBO publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Inactive date provided is in the past.
Invalid request provided.

36F79719D0260 File Attachments

☒ 36F79719D0260

Reason for Error: GSA only allows for a 99 maximum days after Award Date to archive. If user tries to publish and Award Notice after the 99 days, this error will appear (no matter how many days they've entered because it is based on the Award Date).

Solution: Email the user using the template below.

Email Template: send to VA Acquisition Systems Help Desk, but inform the user:

Unfortunately, GSA only allows for a 99 day max archive date and that is based on the Award Date of the action. You will not be able to publish through eCMS, but we can assist in getting the document manually published.

Please provide us with the document, Award Action ID, Solicitation Action ID (if applicable), Award Date, Base & All Options (Total Contract Value), Vendor DUNS, PSC, and NAICS.

We will let you know when the document is published.

Insufficient privileges to create opportunity.

Publish Document: 36S79720Q0002

Solicitation Number: 36S79720Q0002

Document History	Action Type	FBO	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFQ		N/A	N/A	N/A

FBO publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Insufficient privileges to create opportunity.

36S79720Q0002 File Attachments

- ☒ 36S79720Q0002
- ☒ POLYBAGGER SPECIFICATIONS.docx

Reason for Error: The Contracting Office Code in the data values in the action in eCMS must match the same Contracting Office Code from your beta.sam.gov profile.

Solution: This error used to occur often after FBO was rolled over to Contract Opportunities they rolled all of NAC under 36F797. So, when users at NAC not using that Contracting Office Code tried to publish a document against something already on Contract Opportunities, they received an error.

Check "Contracting Office Code" in Contract Opportunities vs. the eCMS action to see if they are different. If they are, and they should be, then the document will need to be manually posted on the post that is already on Contract Opportunities.

If they are different and should not be different (for example, if it is a new solicitation), confirm why the user account is under one site, but action created under another. Resolve this issue and then have the user try to publish again.

Another example is verifying in beta.sam to see if user was given the "Contract Specialist" role instead of "Contract Officer" role. You can update their role accordingly to fix the publishing issue.

Email Template: (read *Solution* above before replying)

Invalid User Email Provider



Reason for Error: User's email address in eCMS doesn't match their email address for beta.sam.gov.

Solution:

1. Check the user's email address in eCMS
2. Check the user's email address for beta.sam.gov
3. Update the user's email address in eCMS (if needed)
4. Email the user to try again.

Email Template:

If not registered at beta.sam.Gov

I just looked in Beta.Sam.gov and do not see that you have registered for an account. To post out to Contract Opportunities, you will need to register for an account.

Attached are instructions on how to register for your Beta.Sam.gov account.

If user's email address is incorrect in ECMS.

I have updated the settings on your eCMS profile. Please try to publish again.

Link with the display text 'eCMS CAARE PORTAL' already exists. Link <https://vaww.ecms.va.gov> already exists.

Publish Document: 36C26321Q0033 0001

Solicitation Number: 36C26321Q0033

Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL	Z-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFQ	10/5/2020			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFQ-AMEND			N/A	N/A

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Link with the display text 'eCMS CARE PORTAL' already exists.
Link 'https://vaww.ecms.va.gov' already exists.

36C26321Q0033 0001 File Attachments

☒ 36C26321Q0033 0001

Choose where you would like to publish this document by clicking on a column in the table above.

OK

Reason for Error: This is the error they get if they try to publish a subsequent Contract Opportunities notice document for that same solicitation/requirement with the SAME website they used before. Contract Opportunities wants it to be blank or a different new website:

Solution: Have the user use a different "URL"

Email Template:

It seems you have already used the URL in the field "Agency Homepage URL". Please go back into the form and update the field with a different website (URL) or leave the field blank (see screenshot below). Then try to publish to Contract Opportunities again.

Notice ID is a required field

Publish Document: GS-35F-0528P 36C10B20F0077_1 ? + ×

Solicitation Number:

Document History	Action Type	FBO	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	FSS-ORDER	3/10/2017			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	FSS-DO-MOD	4/28/2017			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	FSS-ORDER		N/A	N/A	N/A

FBO publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Notice ID is a required field.
Invalid request provided.

GS-35F-0528P 36C10B20F0077_1 File Attachments

- ☒ GS-35F-0528P 36C10B20F0077_1
- ☒ JA - Final SIGNED CA Approved_Redacted.pdf

Reason for Error: The Solicitation ID (Solicitation Number) field on document is blank.

Solution: Note, if the solicitation was published on Contract Opportunities, then the user is able to submit an "Award Notice" document with the Solicitation Number in the Solicitation ID. For these, the solution is to make sure the Solicitation action is connected and enter the Solicitation ID in the blank field on the Contract Opportunities document, then resave document, redo formatting (if any) and republish.

However, if the solicitation was not published on CO, the system will create another error after this one (see "Unique Entity Identifier is invalid. Invalid request provided" error). In those situations, have the user try to enter the Award Action ID in the Solicitation ID field. If that doesn't work, have them create a Special Notice and insert their Award Notice in the "SAM Description" field and then publish.

Email Template: (read *Solution* above before replying)

Opportunity not found with given solicitation and ntype.

Publish Document: 36E79720D0010_1

CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	IDC-CON	N/A	N/A	N/A
------------------------	---------	-----	-----	-----

FBO publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Opportunity not found with given solicitation number and ntype.

36E79720D0010_1 File Attachments

☒ 36E79720D0010_1

Choose where you would like to publish this document by clicking on a column in the table above.

OK

65--Tadalafil Tablets (VA-19-00076550)

Department/Ind. Agency
VETERANS AFFAIRS, DEPARTMENT OF

Sub-tier
VETERANS AFFAIRS, DEPARTMENT OF

Office
NAC FEDERAL SUPPLY SCHEDULE (36F797)

Contract Opportunities

Notice ID
36E79719R0026

Current Date Offers Due
Oct 1, 2019

Last Updated Date
Jan 16, 2020 (3)

Last Published Date
Jan 16, 2020

Type
Updated Solicitation

Reason for Error: When FBO transitioned to Contract Opportunities, all of the NAC posts that were transferred to show up under site "36F797" instead of the individual sites where they were posted from. This is keeping users from being able to publish amendments or Award Notices if their site isn't 36F797.

Check "Contracting Office Code" in Contract Opportunities vs. the eCMS action to see if they are different. If they are, and they should be, then the document will need to be manually posted on the post that is already on Contract Opportunities.

If they are different and should not be different (for example, if it is a new solicitation), confirm why the user account is under one site, but action created under another. Resolve this issue and then have the user try to publish again.

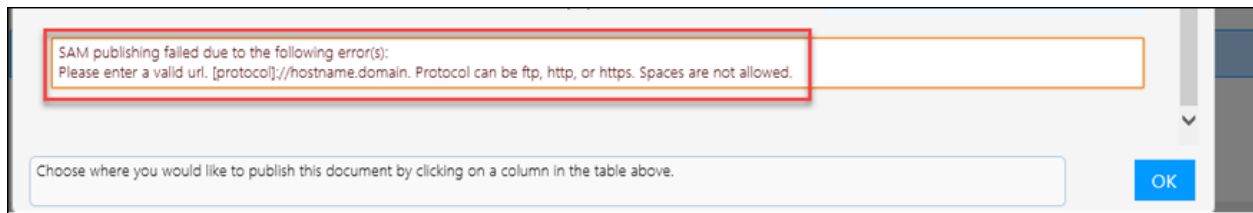
Solution: send to VA Acquisition Systems Help Desk

Email Template: To Help Desk (example)

Can you please publish the Award Notice Document (36E79720D0020_1) for 36E79720D0020 to Contract Opportunities under the solicitation 36E79719R0032?

The user is unable to publish since the solicitation was published before the switch from FBO to Contract Opportunities and the Contracting Office Code for the solicitation (36F797) no longer matches the requirement (36E797).

Please enter a valid URL. [protocol]://hostname.domain. Protocol can be ftp, http, or https Space are not allowed.



SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Please enter a valid url. [protocol]://hostname.domain. Protocol can be ftp, http, or https. Spaces are not allowed.

Choose where you would like to publish this document by clicking on a column in the table above.

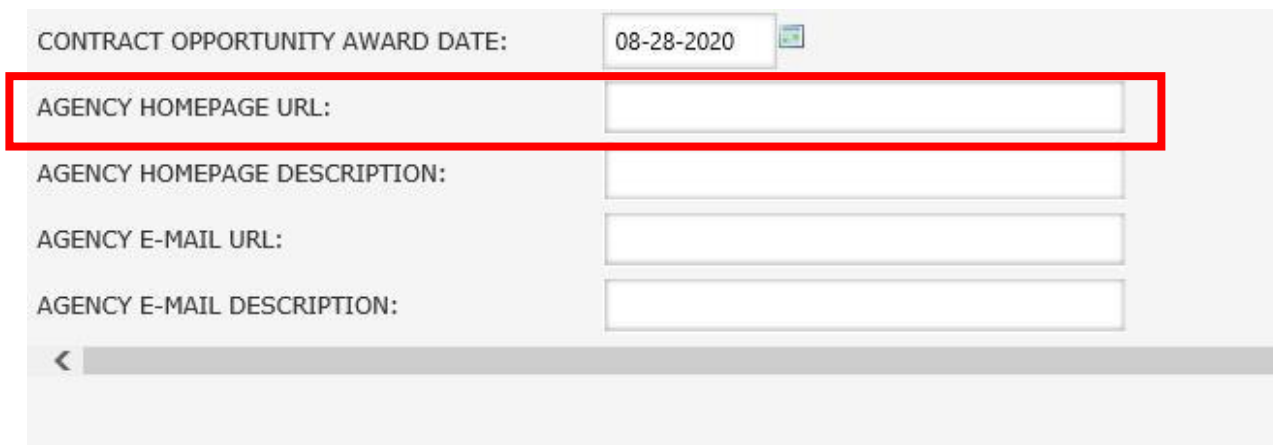
OK

Reason for Error: The URL is missing on the "Agency URL" on the document form.

Solution: Have the user update the "Agency URL" to include a website that contains either ftp, http or https.

Email Template:

It appears you are missing website in the field "Agency Homepage URL". Please update the field "Agency Homepage URL" (screenshot below) to include an URL containing website either [ftp](#), [http](#), or [https](#).



CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY AWARD DATE: 08-28-2020

AGENCY HOMEPAGE URL:

AGENCY HOMEPAGE DESCRIPTION:

AGENCY E-MAIL URL:

AGENCY E-MAIL DESCRIPTION:

<

Primary Contact – Please enter a valid Internet email address. Format: username@host.domain

Publish Document: 36E79720R0043 0001

Solicitation Number: 36E79720R0043

Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFI	3/20/2020			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFP	5/29/2020			
VA-COMMERCIAL-RFP	RFP	6/1/2020			
AMENDMENT 1	RFP-AMEND			N/A	

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Primary Contact - Please enter a valid Internet email address. Format: username@host.domain.

36E79720R0043 0001 File Attachments

☒ 36E79720R0043 0001

Reason for Error: A recent update to Contract Opportunities required an update to eCMS, including the "Point of Contact" and values on the Contract Opportunities documents. The POC data now has specific labels on them: Title, Name, Email, Phone, Fax, Other. Name and Email are required fields.

Solution: Per the email from VACO EAS Communications on 06/05/2020, this error can be resolved by filling in the Point of Contact "Contract Opportunity POC Name" and "Contract Opportunity POC Email" Fill-in in Content Manager. Resave word document and make sure formatting is updated as needed. Have the try to publish again.

Document Fill-Ins

Form: PRESOL Presolicitation Notice - Synopsis

Previous Next Select Segment Data Value View Form View Document Zoom:

ISSUED BY: STREET LINE 4:	5202 Preside	NAICS CODE *	611430
CITY STATE ZIP LINE 5:	Frederick MD	CONTRACTING OFFICE ADDRESS	Strategic Acquisition Center - Frederick Department of Veterans Affairs 5202 Presidents Court, Suite 103 Frederick MD 21703
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC TITLE:		DESCRIPTION *	See Attachment
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC NAME:		POINT OF CONTACT *	
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC EMAIL:			
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC PHONE:			
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC FAX:			
CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC ADDL INFO:			
PLACE OF PERFORMANCE ADDRESS NAME 1:			
PLACE OF PERFORMANCE ADDRESS NAME 2:			

OK

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC NAME

?

+

×

Explanation

Enter the name of the official to contact in regards to the SAM posting. This field is required for all Contract Opportunities postings except Award Notice.

[Details...](#) [RegSearch](#)

Edit Value

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC NAME:

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC EMAIL

?

+

×

Explanation

Enter the email address for the official to contact in regards to the SAM posting. This field is required for all Contract Opportunities postings except Award Notice.

[Details...](#) [RegSearch](#)

Edit Value

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY POC EMAIL:

Email Template: work with the user to update these fields and try to publish again

PSC Expired

Reason for Error: A recent update to eCMS removed 100s of PSC codes that were sunset on 10/29/2020. These PSC codes can not be used anymore even if they were awarded in the past. Users will not be able to put these old PSC codes in the Dialog Session, but just in case they get to publish, the system will not let them publish with an expired PSC Code.

Solution: User needs to update their PSC to match current PSC list from [acquisition.gov](https://www.acquisition.gov) or [fpds.gov](https://www.fpds.gov)

This related Notice's ID is invalid

Solicitation Number: 36C10G20R0019			
Document History	Action Type	SAM	VENDOR PORTAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFP	8/6/2020	
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	▶ IDC-CON		N/A

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
This Related Notice's ID is invalid

36C10G21D0005_1 File Attachments

☒ 36C10G21D0005_1

Reason for Error: If the solicitation posts are archived, the user will not be able to post an Award Notice against it.

Solution: Unarchived the solicitation and we were able to publish the Award Notice.

Email Template:

It appears the Solicitation post was archived in Contract Opportunities. I was able to unarchive for you.

Please try to publish your Award Notice again to Contract Opportunities.

The name should contain only Alpha numeric characters with spaces, no (, - ())

Document History	Action Type	CONTRACT OPPORTUNITIES	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RPI	3/26/2021			
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	RFP		Not Configured	N/A	N/A

SAM publishing failed due to the following error(s):
File name should contain only Alpha numeric characters with spaces, hyphen, underscore and ()

36C10B21R0015_1 File Attachments

- ☒ 36C10B21R0015_1
- ☒ 36C10B21R0015 Final.docx
- ☒ Attachment 1-Price Workbook Gainesville, FL.xlsx

Reason for Error: File name (attachment) can not have (, _ - ()) in the name,

Solution: Have the user resave the file without these special characters.

Email Template:

It appears one of your attachment(s) has (which character) in the file name.

Please resave the attachment without this character and reupload the attachment. Then try publishing document again.

Unique Entity Identifier is invalid. Invalid request provided.

Publish Document: 36F79720D0051

Solicitation Number: 65IB

Document History	Action Type	FBO	VENDOR PORTAL	E-BUY	MANUAL
CONTRACT-OPPORTUNITIES	65IB-FSS		N/A	N/A	N/A

FBO publishing failed due to the following error(s):
Unique Entity Identifier (duns) is invalid.
Invalid request provided.

36F79720D0051 File Attachments

- ☒ 36F79720D0051

Reason for Error: This error occurred used to occur for Award Notices where you were unable to view a vendor's record on SAM.gov without logging in first.

Solution: Help desk has to publish, no workaround.

Email Template: send to VA Acquisition Systems Help Desk

URL Description needed

Reason for Error: They Contract Opportunities requires that if you have Information entered in the field "Agency Homepage URL or Agency Homepage Description ", then it required you have information entered in the field.

will also get an error if they enter an Agency URL without a URL description or vice-versa but I don't have think I have that screenshot.

Solution: Check which of the two field Agency Homepage URL or Agency Homepage Description are missing their form. Then have the user update it.

Email Template: It appears you are missing information in the field (Agency Homepage URL or Agency Homepage Description) on your document form (see screenshot below). Please update the missing field accordingly and then try to republish again.

CONTRACT OPPORTUNITY AWARD DATE:	08-28-2020 
AGENCY HOMEPAGE URL:	
AGENCY HOMEPAGE DESCRIPTION:	
AGENCY E-MAIL URL:	
AGENCY E-MAIL DESCRIPTION:	

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